



FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS — INSURANCE AND PAYMENTS

රක්ෂණ හා ගෙවීම් | காப்பீடு மற்றும் கட்டணங்கள்

Ref: SGH-FAQ-006 | Issued: 01 June 2026 | Rev: 1.0

Dept: Finance and Insurance, Block B Ground Floor | Valid Until: 31

December 2026

INSURANCE

Which insurance companies does the hospital accept?

Serendib General Hospital maintains direct-billing arrangements with AIA Insurance Sri Lanka, Ceylinco Life, Sri Lanka Insurance (SLIC) Government Scheme, Softlogic Life, Allianz Lanka, HNB Assurance, Union Assurance, and LOLC Insurance. For any insurer not on this list, patients settle the bill directly and submit a reimbursement claim to their insurer using the hospital's itemised bill, reports, and discharge summary.

What is direct billing?

Direct billing is an arrangement where Serendib General Hospital submits the patient's medical bill directly to the insurer on the patient's behalf. The patient is responsible only for items not covered under the policy, such as non-covered procedures, amounts above policy limits, and applicable excesses or co-payments. Patients must present a valid insurance card and pre-authorisation letter at admission to activate direct billing.

Do I need to obtain pre-authorisation from my insurer?

Yes, for all planned (elective) admissions and surgical procedures, patients on direct-billing panels are required to obtain written pre-authorisation from their insurer before the procedure date. Pre-authorisation typically takes one to three working days. The Insurance Desk at Ext. 1200 (Monday to Friday, 8:00 am to 5:00 pm) can assist with the required medical information. Emergency admissions do not require pre-authorisation before treatment begins; the Insurance Desk will initiate insurer notification on the patient's behalf within 24 to 48 hours.

Does my insurance cover outpatient consultations?

Coverage for outpatient consultations depends on whether the patient holds an outpatient rider or comprehensive plan in addition to the standard inpatient policy. Most basic health insurance plans in Sri Lanka cover inpatient treatment only. Patients are advised to check their specific policy terms with their insurer before attending an OPD consultation with an expectation of coverage.

Can I get a cost estimate before a planned procedure?

Yes. The Billing Desk (Ext. 1210) can provide a written cost estimate for any planned procedure, covering surgical fees, theatre charges, estimated ward accommodation, and investigation costs based on standard protocols. Estimates are indicative and the final bill may vary depending on the actual duration of the procedure, post-operative course, and any complications or additional treatments required.

PAYMENTS AND BILLING

Do I need to pay a deposit on admission?

Yes. An admission deposit is collected from all patients on admission. Deposits range from LKR 25,000 for a General Ward to LKR 150,000 for a Premium Suite, and LKR 100,000 for ICU or HDU. The deposit is applied against the final bill at discharge. Patients with confirmed insurance pre-authorisation may qualify for a reduced deposit or a full waiver; confirm this with the Insurance Desk at the time of admission.

What payment methods are accepted?

The hospital accepts cash in Sri Lankan Rupees at all cashier desks, Visa and Mastercard (debit and credit), bank transfer to Sampath Bank with reference number confirmation, and online payments through the patient portal for deposits and outstanding balances. Foreign currency in USD, EUR, and GBP is accepted at the International Patient Desk only, converted at the Sampath Bank buying rate on the day of transaction. Insurance direct billing is processed through the Insurance Desk with valid pre-authorisation.

Can I pay my bill in instalments?

Yes, in two ways. Patients paying by credit card may request a three-month interest-free instalment plan on bills above LKR 100,000, subject to bank approval at the time of payment. Patients without insurance or credit card access may apply for a hospital payment plan on bills above LKR 100,000, requiring a minimum deposit of 50% at discharge and the balance payable within 60 days at no interest. A formal written agreement is required; contact the Billing Manager at Ext. 1210.

What is included in my hospital bill?

All bills issued by Serendib General Hospital are itemised by default and will include: ward accommodation charged per night at the applicable ward rate, consultant visit fees per ward round, nursing procedures and clinical consumables, theatre charges disaggregated into surgeon's fee, anaesthetist's fee, theatre room, and disposables, pharmacy items dispensed during admission, investigation charges for tests ordered during the admission period, and any OPD charges incurred within the same episode of care.

What if I think there is an error in my bill?

Patients are requested to raise any billing query at the Billing Desk (Block B, Ground Floor) before the discharge process is finalised wherever possible. Billing queries are reviewed by a senior billing officer. Straightforward queries are resolved on the same day. Queries requiring clinical verification are resolved within 24 hours. If a billing error is confirmed, the correction is applied before the final invoice is issued and any overpayment is refunded within five working days.

What documentation will I receive for an insurance reimbursement claim?

At discharge, the hospital provides a final itemised bill, copies of all investigation reports generated during admission, the discharge summary signed by the treating consultant, pharmacy receipts, and where applicable, surgeon's and anaesthetist's fee notes. Additional documentation such as clinical letters, medical certificates, or operation notes may be requested through the Medical Records Office within five working days at a fee of LKR 500 per document.

Is financial assistance available for patients who cannot afford treatment?

Yes. The Serendib Compassionate Care Fund provides partial subsidies on inpatient bills for patients demonstrating genuine financial hardship. Applications are accepted at the Social Services Office, Block A, Ground Floor, Room 108. Eligibility criteria include demonstrated financial need, Sri Lankan citizenship, and treatment for a life-threatening or chronic condition. Applications are reviewed within 48 hours of submission. All applications are treated with complete confidentiality.

What happens if I am unable to pay my bill at discharge?

Patients who are unable to settle their bill in full at discharge are requested to approach the Billing Manager (Ext. 1210) as early as possible during the admission to discuss available options. The hospital does not withhold medical care or necessary treatment on the grounds of an outstanding balance. However, discharge documentation and prescriptions are released only upon settlement or a formally agreed payment arrangement. Unresolved outstanding balances may be referred to the hospital's recovery process after 60 days.

✓ Digitally Signed

Signatory Mr. Prasanna Gunawardena BSc
 (Accountancy), CA (Sri Lanka)
Position Director of Finance, Serendib General
 Hospital
Cert ID SGH-DS-2026-0170
Signed 2026-06-01 15:16:55 +0530
Algorithm SHA-256 with RSA-2048
Digest c7d1e3a5f2b49c60d8e2a4c6f1b37d84...

✓ Digitally Signed

Signatory Ms. Dilrukshi Fernando MBA
Position Hospital Administrator, Serendib General
 Hospital
Cert ID SGH-DS-2026-0171
Signed 2026-06-01 15:18:37 +0530
Algorithm SHA-256 with RSA-2048
Digest d8e2f4b6a3c50d71e9f3b5d7a2c48e95...

Issued by: SGH PKI Authority v2.1
Certificate chain: SGH-ROOT-CA-2024 > SGH-INT-CA > SGH-DOC-SIGNER
Document integrity verified. Document: SGH-FAQ-006 Rev 1.0

